



HANGING ON

DESPAIR LINGERS during a farmers' rally in protest against the World Trade Organisation meet in New Delhi. The farmers were demanding that agricultural goods should be kept out of the Doha round of negotiations.

CHANDIGARH | Official Abuse

In a strange twist of fate, the Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB), supposed to check illegal drug trade, has found itself on the wrong side of the law again. On September 6, S.K. Sekhri, the officiating zonal director of NCB, Chandigarh, was arrested by the CBI in Delhi for allegedly accepting a bribe of Rs 2 lakh from the owner of a Baddi-based pharma company. Sekhri, recently nominated as a member of the newly-formed Anti-Narcotics Task Force, seized some documents from the pharma company, which was when he asked for a bribe. Even more embarrassing for the NCB, Sekhri is its fourth Chandigarh-based official to be arrested. Seven months ago, his predecessor Saji Mohan was arrested in Mumbai while travelling with a consignment of heroin allegedly pilfered from the bureau. Recently, a CBI court had convicted the NCB's Ravikant Pawar for accepting a bribe of Rs 40,000 from the relative of an accused.

by Arvind Chhabra

SEKHRI IS THE FOURTH NARCOTICS CONTROL BUREAU OFFICIAL TO BE ARRESTED BY ANOTHER LAW-ENFORCEMENT AGENCY.

